

DIRECTIONS *for questions 1 to 4:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Critical human geographers have adopted a more political definition of culture that emerged out of the works of Raymond Williams and Stuart Hall, among others. Rather than viewing culture as a fixed attribute of societies, this approach views culture as always emerging out of struggles among groups with diverging interests and unequal access to power. A key term in this definition is hegemony, that is, the process by which dominant values and practices are maintained through the cooption and dilution of alternative and often oppositional ways of life. Therefore, critical geographic approaches to popular culture tend to focus on how hegemonic meanings and values are reproduced and/or challenged by particular representations of spaces and identities or by certain spatial practices. The denigration of the Appalachian region and subculture in popular film – for example, the perpetuation of the “backward” hillbilly stereotype in Sergeant York and Deliverance – helps urban and suburban Americans to feel better about their own material conditions and lifestyle choices.

Much contemporary geographic research involving popular culture consists of analyses of mass media – especially of the visual media. Photography, film, and television all represent geographies and, therefore, widely disseminate information about places and cultures. Some geographers focus on what they perceive as misrepresentations of places and seek to correct errors found in news stories or even fictional accounts. Other geographers, reacting to critiques of the ability of researchers to objectively know and portray their research subjects that appeared across the social sciences during the 1980s and 1990s, theorize that mass-media images contribute to, or are actually parts of, the production of social spaces and places. Economic development departments in many cities, for example, recruit film production companies to use their streetscapes as movie sets. A successful movie can increase the number of tourists who choose to visit that city. In fact, entire neighborhoods may be altered or preserved for years so that the landscape continues to recall the film in the minds of tourists.

Human geographers also study popular music. Some of this work follows older traditions in cultural geography and maps the hearths and diffusion of particular musical forms. Other research focuses on how music lyrics establish or reproduce particular senses of place. Finally, John Lovering’s study of the global music industry provided insights into how the processes of commodification and globalization interact with local music generation and performance.

There is also an emerging body of work focusing on the bodily practices associated with popular culture. Nigel Thrift uses dance as an example of expressive bodily movements occurring in places that convey thoughts and feelings beyond the reach of spoken or written words. To use an example from tourism geography, places remain tourism destinations only because workers and tourists repeatedly perform certain actions in that space. Such practices include gazing at and photographing a landmark such as the Eiffel Tower, driving a tour bus to designated historic sites, and the seemingly mundane act of donning a bathing suit and lounging on a beach. Thus, play and work, just as much as the representational arts of filming and writing, are pop-cultural performances/practices that constantly reproduce the worlds that people know and experience.

Q1. The ‘political’ definition of culture is based on the presupposition that

- ☐ a) all cultures are dynamic by their very nature, and they never stop changing.
- ☐ b) no two cultures can coexist without shaping and impacting each other.
- ☒ c) **culture is a function of social struggle for power.** ✓ **Your answer is correct**
- ☐ d) stronger cultures sometimes fail to undermine weaker ones.

Q2. The author will approve of which of the following statements about 'the perpetuation of the "backward" hillbilly stereotype in Sergeant York and Deliverance'?

- ☐ a) It showed how hegemonic representations of spaces and identities are challenged by popular film.
- ☐ b) It challenged the existing hegemonic representations of spaces and identities.
- ☒ c) **It was consistent with the prevailing notions about the lifestyles of urban and suburban Americans.** ✖ **Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ d) It misrepresented the Appalachian region to perpetuate a more dominant way of life.

Q3. It can be inferred from the second paragraph that

- ☒ a) **geographers are divided in their opinion about whether mass media destroys or creates cultural spaces.** ✖ Your answer is incorrect
- ☐ b) mass media images can add meaning to particular places or neighbourhoods.
- ☐ c) **geographers seeking authenticity of representation of places and cultures ignore the cascading effects of tourism on a particular place.**
- ☐ d) mass media recreates social spaces in the minds of tourists.

Q4. The study of music by human geographers helps them in all of the following EXCEPT:

- ☒ a) **Understanding the origin and spread of various forms of music** ✖ **Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ b) Studying the interconnectedness of music lyrics and the sense of a place
- ☐ c) **Analysing the impact of globalisation on local music flavours**
- ☐ d) Understanding how to use older traditions of cultural geography to map the spread of music

DIRECTIONS *for questions 5 to 8:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

There are, broadly speaking, three kinds of change that are of interest to ancient historians. First, the historians shared with other thinkers an interest in the development of society from early times to their own day. Thucydides' "Archaeology", the first treatment of this theme in historiography, narrates the rise of Greece from its poor and powerless beginnings to the standards of wealth and surplus of his own day. Polybius takes an even larger view, treating the development of humankind from its savage beginnings to civilized states and societies, even attempting to integrate this with his discussion of political change... In all the cases, however, the treatment of this particular type of change is ancillary to the historians' main narrative, since their interest is focused on what humans do when they have reached the "civilized" stage of their development.

The second type of change with which the ancient historians concerned themselves was constitutional change. This interest was ubiquitous in ancient historiography and reaches a kind of theoretical peak in Polybius' notion of the anacyclosis, a cycle whereby states are said to go through a certain progression involving the three ideal forms of government (monarchy, aristocracy, and democracy) and their debased offspring (respectively: tyranny, oligarchy, and ochlocracy).

As Polybius tells it, men begin in a state of barbarism. The first stage is the rise of a primitive monarch ruling a rude people. He then becomes a true king, but his descendants live luxuriously and wantonly, and this causes the best men to overthrow the monarchy and establish an aristocracy. The descendants of these aristocrats, in turn, likewise fall into depravity, at which point the people rise up and establish a democracy. Over time the people in their turn become corrupted and descend into such savagery that their only hope is a monarch. And thus, the circle is completed...

A third interest of the ancient historians was in rise and fall, both on the grand scale (a nation's advancement and decline) as well as on the small (an individual's reversal of fortune) ... On the grand scale this could be seen in the development of the notion of the "succession" of empires, whereby one great empire eventually gave way to the next. Indeed, Polybius thought that one of his history's most important purposes was to teach individuals how to bear reversals of fortune nobly, by recognizing that great men have often dealt with disasters in their own lives.

This interest in rise and fall sometimes revealed itself in a concern with moral decline. The destructive and long-lasting civil wars of the late republic engendered in the Romans in particular an obsession with explaining how their city, which had risen to such prominence by defeating one foreign foe after another, could then, although mistress of the Mediterranean, destroy itself from within. Both Sallust and Livy sought answers to the question, and if their explanations – the decline of morality ushered in by the very benefits of empire, with the concomitant loss of any considerable rival that could keep Rome in a state of readiness – might strike us as inadequate, the important point is that they recognized the change, and discussed and debated the origins and causes of it.

Q5. All of the following, if true, are inconsistent with Polybius' argument about political change in the third para EXCEPT?

- ☐ a) **Kingdoms lacking strong rulers are taken over by other powerful kingdoms.**
- ☐ b) Democracies can self-correct to prevent their own decline.
- ☐ c) **Monarchs may face a rebellion when they lose control of their state.**
- ☐ d) Aristocracies can merge into a monarchy in the presence of a strong ruler.

Q6. Which of the following best represents the 'larger view' mentioned in the first paragraph of the passage?

- ☐ a) **The rise of Greece from its poor and powerless beginnings to affluence and democracy**
- ☐ b) The development of a kingdom from savagery to civilisation to eventual monarchy
- ☐ c) **The complete cycle of political progression involving a state's rise and downfall**
- ☐ d) The historiography of mankind from barbarism to civilization

Q7. Which of the following, if false, strengthens the arguments attributed to Sallust and Livy in the last paragraph of the passage?

- ☐ a) **Roman prosperity attracted more enemies to scheme against them.**
- ☐ b) Rome's decadence was perpetrated largely by its own prosperity.
- ☐ c) **Rome's moral fortitude laid the foundation for its political prominence.**
- ☐ d) Romans had to constantly guard their prosperous city from enemies outside.

Q8. It CANNOT be inferred about constitutional change that

- ☐ a) **rulers who tend to live luxuriously are eventually overthrown.**
- ☐ b) moral corruption of society leads to a political change.
- ☐ c) **anacyclosis starts and ends with monarchy.**
- ☐ d) concentration of power in corrupt hands triggers social rebellion.

DIRECTIONS *for questions 9 to 12:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Criticism must always be concerned with the poem itself. But a poem does not always exist only in itself: sometimes it has a very lively existence in its false or partial appearances. These simulacra of the actual poem must be taken into account by criticism; and sometimes, in its effort to come at the poem as it really is, criticism does well to allow the simulacra to dictate at least its opening moves. In speaking about Wordsworth's 'Ode: Intimations of Immortality from Recollections of Early Childhood,' I should like to begin by considering an interpretation of the poem which is commonly made. According to this interpretation – I choose for its brevity Dean Spenry's statement of a view which is held by many other admirable critics – the Ode is "Wordsworth's conscious farewell to his art, a dirge sung over his departing powers."

How did this interpretation—erroneous, as I believe—come into being? To be sure, the Ode is not wholly perspicuous. The difficulty does not lie in the diction, which is simple, or even in the syntax, which is sometimes obscure, but rather in certain contradictory statements which the poem makes, and in the ambiguity of some of its crucial words. Yet, the erroneous interpretation does not arise from any intrinsic difficulty of the poem itself but rather from certain extraneous and unexpressed assumptions which some of its readers make about the nature of the mind.

Nowadays, it is not difficult for us to understand that such tacit assumptions about the mental processes are likely to be hidden beneath what we say about poetry. Usually, despite our general awareness of their existence, it requires great effort to bring these assumptions explicitly into consciousness. But in speaking of Wordsworth one of the commonest of our unexpressed ideas comes so close to the surface of our thought that it needs only to be grasped and named. I refer to the belief that poetry is made by means of a particular poetic faculty, a faculty which may be isolated and defined.

It is this belief, based wholly upon assumption, which underlies all the speculations of the critics who attempt to provide us with explanations of Wordsworth's poetic decline by attributing it to one or another of the events of his life. What the biographical critics are telling us is that Wordsworth wrote great poetry by means of a faculty which depended upon his relations with Annette Vallon, or which operated only so long as he admired the French Revolution, or which flourished by virtue of a particular pitch of youthful sense-perception...

Now no one can reasonably object to the idea of mental determination in general, and I certainly do not intend to make out that poetry is an unconditioned activity. Still, this particular notion of mental determination which implies that Wordsworth's genius failed when it was deprived of some single emotional circumstance is so much too simple and so much too mechanical that I think we must inevitably reject it. Nothing less than the whole mind, the whole man, will suffice for its origin...

Q9. Which of the following, if true, will most strengthen the author's opinion about the speculations of critics of the Ode by Wordsworth?

- ☐ a) **A singular emotion alone can never be the basis of a poem.**
- ☐ b) Poetry is the culmination of everything an individual has to offer.
- ☐ c) **Wordsworth's genius was not inspired by any emotional circumstance.**
- ☐ d) Poetry is not an unconditioned activity, but a process of mental determination.

Q10. Which of the following statements resonates with the author's opinion about Dean Sperry's statement on Wordsworth's 'Ode: Intimations of Immortality from Recollections of Early Childhood'?

- ☐ a) **It has been ratified by several admirable critics of Wordsworth.**
- ☐ b) It's an erroneous interpretation of Wordsworth's farewell to his own art.
- ☐ c) **Its diction is simple, but the syntax is complex.**
- ☐ d) It incorrectly attributes Wordsworth's faculty for writing poetry to individual life events.

Q11. Which of the following, if false, contradicts the 'tacit assumptions' mentioned in the third paragraph?

- ☐ a) **Poetry derives its existence from a single, isolated, emotional circumstance.**
- ☐ b) The poetic faculty is an intangible amalgamation of several different experiences.
- ☐ c) **Wordsworth brings our unexpressed ideas close to the surface for us to comprehend.**
- ☐ d) Our own mental processes are hidden beneath what we say about poetry.

Q12. The author mentions that the Ode is not wholly perspicuous to drive home the point that:

- ☐ a) **It has certain contradictory statements and ambiguous word usage.**
- ☐ b) The poem is not dense from a diction and syntax perspective.
- ☐ c) **Readers make extraneous assumptions outside the content of the poem.**
- ☐ d) The wrong interpretation of the Ode doesn't stem from its lack of clarity.

DIRECTIONS for questions 13 to 16: The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

‘Epi’-genetics refers to changes that are not inherited through DNA but rather result from interactions between genetic processes and experience. A research project called the Dutch Hunger Winter Study used the 1944 famine in the Netherlands as a natural experiment, concluding that exposure to specific conditions such as caloric restriction can be linked to epigenetic changes, expressed in symptoms such as tumours. Like the first generation of those caught up in the famine, the second generation also gave birth to low-weight children, demonstrating the inheritance of traits at the cellular and molecular level operating apart from DNA.

Epigenetics serves as a bridge between genotype (literally, the genes) and phenotype (the way the genes are expressed), accounting for the impact of time... Evolutionary scientists refer to development as ‘ontogeny’: even identical twins with the same DNA are different, epigenetically, because each person is embodied, embedded in relations or situations, in distinct and unpredictable ways.

I’ve come to love this term ontogeny because it brings together, in one helpful word, the flux of becoming that scientists as well as existentialists seek to understand. Our longing for existential meaning, as the anthropologist Augustin Fuentes explains in *The Creative Spark* (2017), is a key component of our development as a species. To consider capacities such as choosing or adjudicating meaning, according to him, is to reflect on the long arc of becoming human, a trajectory perhaps best described as the process of hominisation. On this account, our evolutionary emergence as a species is inseparable from the story of earlier, now-extinct species, in particular *Homo erectus*, the animal who roamed in and also far beyond Africa. It is *Homo erectus* who created fire and learned how to hunt, inhabiting and shaping their environments in ways that Fuentes calls ‘niche construction’. They also developed larger brains than their ancestors and, crucially, experienced longer phases of ontogeny or childhood development. These details are what existentialists include under the term ‘facticity’: the physiologies we’re born into, the concrete ways in which we inhabit our ecological spaces.

... Fuentes points out, for example, that modern humans are closer in kinship to chimps and gorillas than to orangutans, an important claim when it comes to scrutinising our contemporaries on the planet for insights into who or why we are... The question of when, precisely, we became ‘us’ is a methodological one for scientists because it begs certain presuppositions about the evidentiary artefacts left behind by our long-gone ancestors. Are the fossils that indicate bipedal, two-legged movement the sign of human-hood? Or are signs of meaning-making behaviour, such as cave art or burying one’s dead, better expressions of human animality because they point to symbolic, complex communication?

In 1944, Beauvoir’s *Pyrrhus and Cineas* was published, in which essay she declared: ‘I am not a thing, but a project.’ This claim is at first glance a descriptive one, pointing out that my actions create meanings that are not established in advance. But the claim is more than that. These actions, in turn, reshape me, how I reach out to the future, and even the world around me, in a kind of existential feedback loop. Every end or existential goal is a point of departure.

Q13. The example of the Dutch Hunger Winter Study demonstrates that

- ☐ a) **caloric restriction maybe caused by epigenetic changes.**
- ☐ b) inheritance of traits happens at a molecular level without involving DNA
- ☒ c) **not all traits are inherited through DNA.** ✓ **Your answer is correct**
- ☐ d) second-generation traits are inherited from outside the DNA

Q14. The term 'ontogeny' in the context of the passage is most likely to mean which of the following?

- ☐ a) **The longing experienced by humans for existential meaning**
- ☐ b) One's development over time into a unique individual
- ☐ c) **Becoming scientists and existentialists at the same time**
- ☐ d) Being genetically similar but epigenetically different

Q15. All of the following, if true, help us better evaluate the 'presuppositions' mentioned in the penultimate paragraph of the passage EXCEPT:

- ☐ a) **Human animality must involve aspects that go beyond basic survival.**
- ☐ b) Evolutionary changes separating humans from the ancestors they share with chimps and gorillas define human-hood.
- ☐ c) **Chimps, gorillas and orangutans all share a common ancestor with humans.**
- ☐ d) Higher cognition required for meaning-making behaviour is central to human animality.

Q16. Which of the following, if proven to be false, contradict the author's statement that 'our evolutionary emergence as a species is inseparable from the story of earlier, now-extinct species, in particular Homo Erectus'?

- ☐ a) **There is no evidence to show that modern humans have descended from Homo Erectus.**
- ☐ b) Modern humans are more similar to Homo Erectus than to chimps and gorillas.
- ☐ c) **The process of hominisation was kickstarted by the event of creation of fire by Homo Erectus.**
- ☐ d) Modern humans belong to the same branch of hominins that Homo Erectus belongs to.

Q17. DIRECTIONS *for questions 17 and 18:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

There is a growing consensus in early hominin studies that savannahs did not play a significant role in the emergence of human evolutionary processes. Early hominins have been reported to be associated with densely wooded environments and sometimes forest, thereby reducing the importance of a shift from closed to open ecosystems in shaping these processes. In the second half of the twentieth century, two versions of the savannah hypothesis emerged: one depicted savannah as grasslands, the other as seasonal mosaic environments. Research has shown that the former is no longer tenable, but an increasing amount of paleoecological information provides compelling support for the latter.

- ☐ a) **Hominin studies have led to reshaping our understanding of the savannahs and their role in human evolution.**
- ☐ b) New research on savannahs has led to a recalibration of what was once considered to have played a significant role in human evolution.
- ☐ c) **Savannahs as seasonal mosaic environments provide compelling evidence of their less significant role in human evolution.**
- ☐ d) The role of the savannahs in human evolution was misunderstood because of our incorrect understanding of what they were.

Q18. DIRECTIONS *for questions 17 and 18:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

All truly liberal societies are in principle dedicated to the elimination of conventional sources of inequality. In addition, the dynamism of capitalist economies tends to break down many conventional and cultural barriers to equality through its continually changing demand for labor. A century of Marxist thought has accustomed us to think of capitalist societies as highly inegalitarian, but the truth is that they are far more egalitarian in their social effects than the agricultural societies they replaced. Capitalism is a dynamic force which constantly attacks purely conventional social relationships, replacing inherited privilege with new stratifications based on skill and education.

- ☐ a) **Contrary to its misrepresentation by Marxist thought, capitalism challenges inequality perpetuated by social and cultural stratifications.**
- ☐ b) Capitalism is egalitarian and dynamic because it allows skill and education to replace social and cultural relationships.
- ☒ c) **Liberal societies are egalitarian because they eliminate conventional sources of inequality just as capitalist societies do.** ✖ Your answer is incorrect
- ☐ d) Capitalist societies are egalitarian because they provide an opportunity for those with skill and education to question the status quo.

Q19. DIRECTIONS *for question 19:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. It's a bit unsettling to think that our home is constantly being peppered by stones falling from the sky.
2. Details of the violent processes that formed Earth and the other inner planets are beautifully preserved in the amazingly diverse varieties of meteorites.
3. Even when scholars began to describe meteorite falls more formally, little in the way of reproducible scientific evidence could be mustered to document them, much less explain their provenance.
4. In fact, the scientific community didn't pay them much heed until about two hundred years ago, though there was certainly no shortage of colorful meteorite anecdotes in folklore.

Q20. DIRECTIONS *for question 20:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

The historian starts with a provisional selection of facts, and a provisional interpretation in the light of which that selection has been made - by others as well as by himself. As he works, both the interpretation and the selection and ordering of facts undergo subtle and perhaps partly unconscious changes, through the reciprocal action of one or the other. And this reciprocal action also involves reciprocity between present and past, since the historian is part of the present and the facts belong to the past. The historian and the facts of history are necessary to one another. The historian without his facts is rootless and futile; the facts without their historian are dead and meaningless.

- ☐ a) **Historians cannot help but unconsciously alter the selection and ordering of facts based on their own interpretation of those facts.**
- ☐ b) The reciprocity between the past and the present is obvious in how historians select facts and interpret them.
- ☐ c) **The selection of facts by a historian and the historian's interpretation of those facts dynamically influence each other.**
- ☐ d) How a historian selects the facts influences the former's interpretation of those said facts, which in turn influences how we view the past.

Q21. DIRECTIONS *for question 21:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. Scientists wrote beautifully through the 19th century and on into the early 20th.
2. The insistence on bland impersonality and the widespread indifference to anything like the display of a unique human author in scientific exposition. have transformed the reading of most scientific papers into an act of tedious drudgery.
3. Over the past fifty years or so, scientists have allowed the conventions of expression available to them to become entirely too confining.
4. But somewhere after that, coincident with the explosive growth of research, the art of writing science suffered a grave setback, and the stultifying convention descended that the best scientific prose should sound like a non-human author addressing a mechanical reader.

Q22. DIRECTIONS *for question 22:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.
Sentence: Like the master score of a bewitchingly complex symphonic work, the genome contains the instructions for the development and maintenance of organisms.

Paragraph: _____(1)_____ Even though every cell contains the same set of genes – an identical genome – the selective activation or repression of particular subsets of genes allows an individual cell to respond to its environments. _____(2)_____. The genome was an active blueprint—capable of deploying selected parts of its code at different times and in different circumstances. Proteins act as regulatory sensors, or master switches, turning on and turning off genes, or even combinations of genes, in a coordinate manner. _____(3)_____. But the genomic “score” is inert without proteins. _____(4)_____. Proteins actualize this information—by activating or repressing genes. They conduct the genome, thereby playing out its music—activating the viola at the fourteenth minute, a crash of cymbals during the arpeggio, a roll of drums at the crescendo.

- ☐ a) **Option 1**
- ☐ b) Option 2
- ☐ c) **Option 3**
- ☐ d) Option 4

Q23. DIRECTIONS *for question 23:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. Nonetheless, it would be inaccurate to characterize all national members of cartels as benevolent market economies; recent controversies in Saudi Arabia, Russia, and Venezuela suggest otherwise.
2. Cartels can afford member nations a way in which to countervail the forces imposed by transnational corporations such as Exxon, Shell, and Alcoa.
3. Multinational corporations' first allegiance is to investors and not to the needs of the exporting nations.
4. So long as labor costs for mineral extraction help keep mineral extraction in developing nations lower than comparable sites in more developed nations, cartels will exercise considerable power, especially in the hydrocarbon sectors.

Q24. DIRECTIONS *for question 24:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: Social and economic change extend political consciousness, multiply political demands, broaden political participation.

Paragraph: If men are to remain civilized or to become so, the art of associating together must grow and improve in the same ratio in which the equality of conditions is increased. ____ (1) _____. The political instability in Asia, Africa, and Latin America derives precisely from the failure to meet this condition: equality of political participation is growing much more rapidly than "the art of associating together." ____ (2) _____. These changes undermine traditional sources of political authority and traditional political institutions. ____ (3) _____. They enormously complicate the problems of creating new bases of political association and new political institutions combining legitimacy and effectiveness. ____ (4) _____. The rates of social mobilization and the expansion of political participation are high; the rates of political organization and institutionalization are low. The result is political instability and disorder.

☐ a) **Option 1**

☐ b) Option 2

☐ c) **Option 3**

☐ d) Option 4